

Nova Digital — Comprehensive Paid Time Off (PTO) & Leave Policy

1. Policy Purpose & Broad Scope

At Nova Digital, we recognize that rested and healthy team members build superior digital solutions. This policy outlines our standards for annual vacation accrual, dedicated medical/sick leaves, parental leave programs, bereavement considerations, and mandatory rest periods. This policy applies uniformly to all full-time regular employees across all geographic locations, subject to applicable municipal statutory minimums.

2. Paid Time Off (PTO) Accrual Schedules

Nova Digital operates on an annualized accrual model credited to employee accounts semi-monthly on each pay cycle (the 15th and the final calendar day of each month). PTO encompasses vacation, recreational rest, personal projects, and discretionary time away.

Tenure Tier	Years of Service	Annual Allocation	Semi-Monthly Accrual Rate
Tier 1 (Associate / Mid)	0 – 2 Years	18 Business Days (144 Hours)	6.00 Hours / Pay Cycle
Tier 2 (Senior / Lead)	3 – 5 Years	22 Business Days (176 Hours)	7.33 Hours / Pay Cycle
Tier 3 (Principal / Executive)	5+ Years	25 Business Days (200 Hours)	8.33 Hours / Pay Cycle

Accruals begin immediately on the employee's first official date of employment. Employees may borrow up to a maximum deficit of 24 accrued hours (-3 days) with direct People Manager authorization in writing via BambooHR.

3. Year-End Rollover & "Use-It-or-Lose-It" Cap

To encourage continuous rejuvenation and minimize administrative liabilities, Nova Digital caps year-end PTO rollovers:

- **Maximum Rollover:** A maximum of **5 unused business days (40 hours)** can be carried over from one calendar year into the subsequent year.
- **Rollover Expiration Window:** Carried-over hours must be scheduled and taken before **March 31st** of the new calendar year. Unused rollover balance automatically lapses on April 1st.
- **No Cash-Out for Active Staff:** Active employees cannot convert unused accrued PTO into cash compensation. In cases of official employment separation, accrued and unused standard PTO (excluding rollover) will be paid out on the final settlement paycheck.

Rollover Deadline Notice: Employees with rollover balances will receive automated Slack and email notifications on February 15th and March 15th through BambooHR reminding them of pending expirations.

4. Dedicated Sick & Wellness Leave

Nova Digital provides **10 dedicated paid Sick & Mental Wellness Days (80 hours)** per calendar year, fully allotted on January 1st (or prorated for new hires based on start month). Sick leave is separate from standard PTO accruals.

- **Permissible Usages:** Personal illness, medical consultations, physical recovery, unexpected care for immediate family dependents, and mental health decompression.
- **Medical Certificate Threshold:** Medical practitioner notes are *not* required for absences lasting two (2) consecutive business days or fewer. For illnesses extending to three (3) or more consecutive business days, an official physician clearance note must be uploaded to BambooHR before returning to active duties.

- **Same-Day Notification Rule:** Team members must notify their manager and log "Out Sick" in BambooHR no later than **09:00 AM local time** on the day of absence.

5. Parental & Family Expansion Leave

Nova Digital is committed to supporting expanding families through inclusive, gender-neutral parental leave:

- **Primary Caregiver Leave:** **16 consecutive weeks** of 100% base-salary paid leave for birth, adoption, or surrogate placement.
- **Secondary Caregiver Leave:** **8 consecutive weeks** of 100% base-salary paid leave.
- **Tenure Eligibility:** Employees become eligible after completing **6 months of continuous service** prior to the anticipated delivery or placement date.
- **Flexibility Window:** Parental leave may be taken anytime within the first twelve (12) months following birth or legal custody transfer. Intermittent parental leave requires prior People Operations sign-off.

6. Bereavement Leave

Compassionate leave is granted to employees experiencing the loss of loved ones without deduction from PTO balances:

- **Immediate Family Members:** Up to **5 consecutive paid business days** (Spouse, domestic partner, child, parent, sibling, legal guardian).
- **Extended Family Members:** Up to **3 consecutive paid business days** (Grandparent, grandchild, parent-in-law, aunt, uncle).
- **Additional Travel Allowance:** If travel exceeding 500 miles (or international transit) is required, an additional 2 unpaid or PTO-substituted days may be requested without penalty.

7. Civic Duties: Jury Duty and Voting Allocations

- **Jury Service:** Nova Digital provides up to **10 paid business days** for mandated civic jury duty. Summons verification must be submitted to People Operations.
- **Voting Leave:** Employees receive up to **2 consecutive paid hours** on official municipal, regional, or national polling days if their work shift does not allow at least 3 consecutive non-working hours while polls remain open.

8. PTO Submission & Approval Workflow

All time-off requests must be formally submitted through the **BambooHR Portal** following these advance notice guidelines:

- **1 to 2 Days Absence:** At least 24 hours advance submission.
- **3 to 5 Days Absence:** At least 2 weeks (10 business days) advance submission.
- **More than 5 Days Absence:** At least 4 weeks (20 business days) advance submission to ensure cross-team sprint coverage.

Key Escalation Contact: For specialized leave inquiries, FMLA filings, or disability accommodations, contact people-ops@novadigital.internal or join the private Slack channel #ask-people-ops.